



ever inventive. The building, especially its principal facade, seems little more than a kind of factory, with wide, repeated iron-framed windows. However, sudden details intrude and symmetry is cast aside. The same mixture of the dutiful and the subversive, the rational and the organic, spreads through the interior. In May 2014, the building was extensively damaged by fire. In June 2018, a second, more serious fire left its future in doubt.

Vittorio Emanuele II Monument

Location Rome, Italy

Although celebrating the reunification of Italy, the immense Vittorio Emanuele II Monument is a structure that looks decisively to the Roman and Renaissance past for its inspiration. It was designed by Giuseppe Sacconi. Built intermittently from 1885, it was finally completed in 1935. An equestrian statue of Vittorio Emanuele is placed in the middle of a vast, white-marbled stage set at the head of an imposing flight of steps. Behind him, a colonnade recalling St. Peter's Square (see pp.158–159) ends in two Roman temple fronts, topped by bronze chariots. Numerous other sculptural groups embody virtues such as work, liberty, sacrifice, and patriotism. Fountains to the left and right symbolize the Adriatic and Tyrrhenian Seas.

► THE BRONZE STATUE OF VITTORIO EMANUELE II SET UPON A MARBLED STAGE



City Hall, Stockholm

Location Stockholm, Sweden

The City Hall in Stockholm, designed by Swedish architect Ragnar Östberg, was built in 1911–1923. It belongs to no obvious architectural style, but draws elements from many. It is detailed, inside and out, and, although brick-built, its impact is anything but utilitarian. Its most dominant external feature is the immense, tapering tower on the southeast corner of the building. On top sits an open copper lantern under a squashed golden dome, capped by three crowns—a Swedish national emblem—at its apex. The arches that face the water on the main facade, with blank expanses of wall above, are reminiscent of the Doge's Palace in Venice (see pp.144–145). Inside, the building contains offices and a series of grand assembly rooms and halls, including the Blue Hall, which hosts the annual banquet for the awarding of Nobel Prizes.

Notre Dame du Raincy

Location Le Raincy, France

If ever a cathedral could be said to have been entirely modern while remaining Gothic in spirit, it is Notre Dame du Raincy, northeast of Paris. It was built in 1922–1923 by Auguste Perret as a memorial to the Battle of the Marne (September 6–12, 1914). The most interesting aspect of the building is that it uses undecorated, reinforced concrete. There is no architectural elaboration, merely a nave flanked by two aisles whose arches, supported on slender columns, are so shallow as to seem undulating. However, it is a structure that allows soaring walls that consist almost exclusively of glass. The exterior of this building is dominated by a tower that looks like a skyscraper.

other precisely. The result is a building that exudes confidence and manages to be simultaneously uplifting and brooding.

Glasgow School of Art

Location Glasgow, Scotland

Charles Rennie Mackintosh's Glasgow School of Art was built in two phases: between 1897 and 1899, and in 1907. It is the most original and important Art Nouveau building in Britain. While it found admirers across Europe, it had few in Britain. It is a building of astonishing complexity. Playful and stern, it is constricted by its site but is